Hoping Is Not Hopping

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 6, Episode 9

Lark read Nib's note as hopping and began to demonstrate, then caught herself beside the carefully aligned press. Nib pointed to the long-vowel base he had intended. He wanted to describe hoping for success, not bouncing near the rollers.

“I was hoping, not hopping,” Nib protested earnestly. “A useful difference,” Lark replied with amusement.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **running**

“Compare hop and hope,” Lark modeled clearly. “Hop doubles p for hopping. Hope drops its final e before ing to make hoping, while the long vowel remains. Make becomes making in the same way. Read the bases before comparing the changed words.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try hoping, making. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read hoping and hopping,” Lark invited gently. “Which word matches Nib's intended meaning without asking anyone to jump?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **I am hoping. Sam is making a box.**

“Who is making something?” Lark asked gently. “Does the first sentence say the speaker is hopping?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib corrected the progress note. Lark reread the whole sentence and understood his meaning. The press stayed still throughout the word comparison. Now the fitted tray, short handle, feed, page supply, and cover could become one portable station rather than separate successes scattered across a bench.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write hoping beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal kept the two spellings with their different meanings. The message was clear. The next test returned to the unchanged door and the original requirement that the station must travel.